Antistatic Wrist Strap

Category: **Safety & PPE** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 3 labs

Covers these lab items: Antistatic wrist wrap

What it is used for

To safely discharge static electricity from a user when handling electrostatic-sensitive electronic components. To reduce electrostatic discharge risk by using a compatible wrist strap and verified grounding point.

Main parts

- Conductive wrist band
- Adjustable strap
- Grounding cord
- Resistor or safety element
- Grounding connector

Before you start

1. Check the wrist strap, cord, connector, and band for damage.
2. Confirm that the workstation has an approved ESD grounding point.
3. Test the strap using an approved wrist-strap tester when required.
4. Ensure the strap is suitable for the electronics work area and procedure.

How to use

1. Place the band snugly against bare skin as instructed.
2. Connect the grounding cord to the designated ESD point.
3. Verify the connection or test result according to the workstation procedure.
4. Handle sensitive components by their edges and avoid touching contacts.
5. Keep the strap connected while working in the designated ESD area.
6. Disconnect and store the strap after completing the task.

⚠ Safety

- Never connect an ESD wrist strap to mains live, neutral, or protective earth terminals except through an approved ESD grounding system.
- Do not use a wrist strap when working on energized electrical equipment where it creates a shock hazard.
- Replace damaged straps or cords.
- Follow the site's ESD and electrical safety procedures.

Care & storage

- Clean the band according to the manufacturer's instructions.
- Inspect the cord and resistor regularly.
- Store without sharp bends or heavy objects on the cord.
- Retest according to the workplace schedule.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Connecting to an unapproved grounding point.
- Wearing the band over clothing instead of against skin.
- Using a damaged cord or failed strap.
- Using the strap around energized equipment without assessing shock risk.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.